

Aleksei Opacic

EDUCATION

Harvard University

PhD Sociology

Expected 2027

AM Statistics

2024

University of Oxford

MSc. Sociology, *Distinction (Ranked First)*

2019

University of Cambridge

BA Social and Political Science, *Starred First Class (Ranked First)*

2018

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Educational Inequality, Organizations, Economic Sociology, Quantitative and Computational Methods

PUBLICATIONS

- 2026 **Opacic, Aleksei**, Lai Wei, and Xiang Zhou. “[Disparity Analysis: A Tale of Two Approaches](#)”. *Journal of the Royal Statistical Society Series A: Statistics in Society*, 00, 1–29.
- 2024 Bloome, Deirdre, and **Aleksei Opacic**. “[Absolute Income Mobility Obscures Marginalized Children’s Disadvantages](#)”. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 121 (25).

WORKING PAPERS

- 2026 “Who Gets to Use Their College Skills? Skill-Job Alignment and Inequality in the College-to-Work Transition”.
- Geoffrey Tootell Award, Mathematical Sociology Section, American Sociological Association
- 2026 “[From Flagship to Firm: Gatekeeping, Employer Sorting, and the Returns to College](#)”.
- Ronald Burt Student Paper Award, Economic Sociology Section, American Sociological Association, Honorable Mention
- 2026 “[Where Do the Returns to Schooling Come From? Educational Transitions and Labor Market Payoffs](#)”. *Revise and Resubmit (2nd)*, *Annals of Applied Statistics*.
- Clifford C. Clogg Graduate Student Paper Award, Methodology Section, American Sociological Association
 - Outstanding Graduate Student Paper Award, Mathematical Sociology Section, American Sociological Association
- 2025 “[Marginal Interventional Effects](#)” (with Xiang Zhou). *Reject and Resubmit*, *Statistical Science*.
- 2025 “[Assumption Smuggling in Tests of Causal Mechanisms](#)” (with Matthew Blackwell and Ruofan Ma).

WORKS-IN-PROGRESS

- 2026 “Matchmakers and Gatekeepers: AI Recommendations and Racial Disparities in Hiring”.
- 2026 “Explaining Gradational Inequalities” (with Lai Wei and Xiang Zhou).

BOOK CHAPTERS

- 2022 Evans, Geoffrey, and Aleksei Opacic. “[How Social Class Influences Political Choices](#)”. *The Cambridge Handbook of Political Psychology*, eds. Danny Osborne and Chris G. Sibley. Cambridge University Press. pp. 382–398.

SOFTWARE

- 2025 “disparity: Estimation of Descriptive and Prescriptive Disparity Estimands” (with Lai Wei and Xiang Zhou). github.com/alekseiopacic/disparity

OTHER WRITING

- 2024 “[Education to Workforce Pathways Diagnostic Toolkit: Analysis Narrative](#)” (with Atticus Bolyard, Sue Dynarski, Jon Fullerton, Miriam Greenberg, Julia Lubner, Eric Taylor, and Rachel Worsham).
- 2024 “[Education to Workforce Pathways Diagnostic Toolkit: Technical Guide](#)” (with Atticus Bolyard, Sue Dynarski, Jon Fullerton, Miriam Greenberg, Julia Lubner, Eric Taylor, and Rachel Worsham).

COURSES TAUGHT

HARVARD UNIVERSITY

- 2022–3 Teaching Fellow, Intermediate Quantitative Methods. *Certificate of Distinction in Teaching*
- 2025 Teaching Fellow, Advanced Quantitative Methods.

RESEARCH AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

- 2026 Geoffrey Tootell Outstanding Dissertation-in-Progress Award, ASA Mathematical Sociology Section (\$5,000)
- 2025 IQSS Research Grant (\$2,000)
- 2025 James M. and Cathleen D. Stone Research Grant (\$5,000)
- 2024 IQSS Research Grant (\$3,000)
- 2024 Russell Sage Foundation Dissertation Research Grant (\$10,000)
- 2024 Center for American Political Studies Seed Grant, Harvard University (\$1,000)
- 2024 Jeanne Humphrey Block Dissertation Award, Harvard University (\$2,500)
- 2024 Population Center Dissertation Research Award, Harvard University (\$2,000)
- 2023 Linda G. Hammett Ory Fellowship, Harvard Graduate School of Education (\$15,000)
- 2020 Kennedy Scholarship, Harvard University (\$20,000)
- 2019 The A.H. Halsey Prize, University of Oxford
- 2018 The Polity Prize, The Pollard Memorial Prize, and King’s College Scholarship, University of Cambridge

INVITED TALKS

- 2026 Harvard Data Science Initiative (HDSI), Harvard University
- 2026 Quantitative Social Science Colloquium, Dartmouth College
- 2025 Education Data Science Seminar, Stanford University
- 2025 Economic Sociology Seminar, Harvard University/MIT
- 2024 Applied Statistics Workshop, Harvard University
- 2023 Inequality Workshop, Stanford University
- 2022 Social Demography Seminar, Harvard University

SELECTED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- 2026 “Who Gets to Use Their College Skills? Skill-Job Alignment and Inequality in the College-to-Work Transition”. Annual Meeting of the Population Association of America, St. Louis, MO (April).
- 2025 “From Flagship to Firm: Gatekeeping, Employer Sorting, and the Returns to College”. Annual Meeting of the American Sociological Association, Chicago, IL (August).
- 2024 “Assumption Smuggling in Tests of Causal Mechanisms” (with Matthew Blackwell and Ruofan Ma). Annual Meeting of the American Political Science Association, Philadelphia, PA (August).
- 2024 “Absolute Income Mobility Obscures Marginalized Children’s Disadvantages” (with Deirdre Bloome). Annual Meeting of the American Sociological Association, Montreal, CA (August).
- 2024 “Cumulative Disadvantage and the BA Attainment Gap”. Annual Meeting of the American Sociological Association, Montreal, CA (August).
- 2024 “Absolute Income Mobility Obscures Marginalized Children’s Disadvantages” (with Deirdre Bloome). Annual Meeting of the Population Association of America, Columbus, OH (April).
- 2024 “Path-Specific Effects under Monotonic Mediation”. Annual Meeting of the Population Association of America, Columbus (April).
- 2023 “Path-Specific Effects under Monotonic Mediation”. Annual Meeting of the American Sociological Association, Philadelphia, PA (August).
- 2023 “Disparity Analysis: A Tale of Two Approaches” (with Lai Wei and Xiang Zhou). Annual Meeting of the International Sociological Association, Melbourne, Australia (June, Declined).
- 2023 “Does Higher Education Tend Towards Egalitarianism? Evidence from a Population Transitions Model”. Annual Meeting of the Population Association of America, New Orleans, LA (April).
- 2022 “An Interventional Approach to Primary and Secondary Effects in Intergenerational Mobility”. Annual Meeting of the American Sociological Association, Los Angeles, CA (August).
- 2022 “Marginal Interventional Effects” (with Xiang Zhou). Annual Meeting of the American Sociological Association, Los Angeles, CA (August).

EXPERIENCE

Netflix

2025

Experimentation & Causal Inference Intern

SERVICE

- Sociology Tenure-Track Faculty Search Committee, Harvard University. 2024–2025
- Sociology Graduate Admissions Committee, Harvard University. 2021–2022
- *Invited Reviewer*: American Journal of Sociology, American Sociological Review, Social Forces, Sociology of Education, Political Behavior, Research in Social Stratification and Mobility, Sociological Methods and Research

AFFILIATIONS

American Sociological Association; Population Association of America; American Statistical Association; Institute for Quantitative Social Science, Harvard; Center for Population and Development Studies, Harvard School of Public Health; EdRedesign, Harvard Graduate School of Education

REFERENCES

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